5 Working with forms: Model binding

This chapter covers

- Model binding in Razor Pages
- Binding complex objects easily
- Protecting your application by validating user input
- Leveraging data annotation attributes to manage validation

At the beginning of this book, I congratulated you for choosing *ASP.NET Core Razor Pages in Action* if you wanted to learn how to build "page-focused interactive web applications." I didn't really expand on the meaning of "interactive" at the time; essentially, an interactive web application is one in which users can provide input and affect the behavior of the application. In the last chapter, you saw how a user can alter a URL to interact with the application, causing the City page to display different content based on the value of a route parameter. In this chapter, you will begin to understand and work with the primary interaction mechanism in a web application: the form.

Forms come in all shapes and sizes. At the beginning of this book, you looked at the Manning website home page, which features a couple of forms that have a single input each. Other forms—insurance quote forms spring to my mind—can span multiple pages. If you want to build interactive web applications, you are going to have to work with forms at some stage, whether it is just a simple contact form or a large, CRUD-based system that drives critical business goals. You will need to create the forms and process the data they are designed to capture. You will also need to validate the data